Kevan Maxwell Davis

Staff AI Product Engineer | Developer Platforms, Extensibility & Applied AI

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PROFILE

Staff-level, product-minded engineer with 20 years of software development across Gilt, Handshake, and Shopify. I turn new technical capabilities into tools people use: developer APIs and extension systems, agent workflows, and applied generative AI. Most recently, I re-architected a multimodal AI creation platform, built agent-facing tools, and contributed to commerce platforms. I prefer hands-on engineering, ambitious prototypes, and technical leadership through collaboration and mentoring.

SELECTED WORK

Shopp-E | Multimodal AI creation platform | Shopify

- Re-architected **Shopp-E**, an internal multimodal platform, as an **isomorphic TypeScript library on Vercel AI SDK**, usable from a web app, CLI, and MCP interface so employees and coding agents could generate media.
- Designed a model registry capturing capabilities, provider limits, and costs; added async jobs, failover, video polling, and multimodal support for image, video, speech, and music.
- The system generated **100,000+ images**, with daily generation frequently exceeding **1,000** and sometimes **2,000**; received recognition from Shopify CEO Tobi Lütke.

AI-powered merchant template migration | Shopify

- Independently devised a prototype to adapt heavily customized Liquid email templates to new product capabilities, addressing a compatibility problem affecting **500,000+ merchants**.
- Designed structure-aware code transformation and a validation loop combining parsing, rendered screenshot comparisons, a vision-model judge, and human review. Achieved **about 90% success on a small curated benchmark** spanning five representative template types and five merchant configurations. Led a six-engineer production development effort that was canceled before launch; no customer templates were migrated.

Agent engineering and developer experiences | Shopify

- Built a code-review council in which lightweight classifiers route PRs to specialized reviewers; consolidated findings into guided reviews with diagrams and occasional screenshot comparisons. Piloted with a small group of engineers.
- Built Pi extensions for fast, multi-model safety judgments with human override, web-to-Markdown retrieval, rich editing, and extension-rendered UI panes; collaborated on **Pi IDE** developer-facing modal, prompt, and notification APIs.
- Added early plugin support to Shopify's internal LibreChat deployment and explored Shopp-E integrations.

Developer extensibility platforms | Shopify

- Before Shopify's checkout Code Red initiative, explored React-based checkout extensibility; partnered with a Principal Engineer, focusing on the **developer-facing API and experience** for sandboxed remote UI while collaborating on integration. The underlying model informed production Checkout UI Extensions.
- Later extended UI extensions to Shopify's Admin product detail page, implementing the initial Bundles card and contributing to Shopify Bundles across Admin and checkout.

EXPERIENCE

Shopify | Staff Software Engineer (2021–November 2026); Senior Software Engineer (May 2019–2021)

Handshake, acquired by Shopify | Senior Developer / Engineer (October 2014–May 2019). Modernized the B2B commerce product toward React and built self-service wholesale and catalog features.

Gilt Groupe | Web Developer → Senior Web Developer (April 2009–August 2014). Built frontend infrastructure, shared libraries, cart and checkout systems.

Earlier: Mindspark Interactive Networks; Tyler Technologies; University of Texas at Arlington AI Lab.

TECHNICAL BREADTH

TypeScript, JavaScript, React, Node.js, Vercel AI SDK, Pi, MCP, OpenAI/Anthropic/Gemini model APIs, multimodal generation, agent orchestration, model evaluation and safety, developer experience, reusable libraries and APIs, Ruby on Rails, PostgreSQL, MySQL, Docker, Kubernetes.

Education: B.S., Computer Science, University of Texas at Arlington.

Patent: Named co-inventor, U.S. 11,403,658, *Systems and methods for providing post-transaction offers* (2022).